



Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>

RE: NCC3896/2023 Cooke – Confirmation of Participation and Request for Remote Appearance [SEC=OFFICIAL]

5 messages

Associate JudgeBetts <Associate.JudgeBetts@fcfcoa.gov.au>

Tue, Oct 28, 2025 at 3:54 AM

To: Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>, JLM Admin <admin@jlmfamilylawyers.com.au>, Anna Roberts <aroberts@delaneyroberts.com.au>

Cc: "reception@delaneyroberts.com.au" <reception@delaneyroberts.com.au>, Olivia Shedden <oshedden@delaneyroberts.com.au>, "ncc38962023@federalcourts.gov.au" <ncc38962023@federalcourts.gov.au>

OFFICIAL

Good morning,

I refer to the below email.

The matter has been listed before his Honour on **Monday, 3 November 2025 at 9.30am** to consider the request to attend electronically.

All parties have leave to appear by video on this occasion. Please use the following video-link for the appearance on Monday.

<https://fcfcoa.webex.com/meet/JudgeBettsCourtroom>

Kind regards,

Chambers of his Honour Judge Betts

Federal Circuit and Family Court of Australia

p. (02) 4250 6726 | e. associate.judgebetts@fcfcoa.gov.au | w. www.fcfcoa.gov.au



FEDERAL CIRCUIT AND FAMILY COURT OF AUSTRALIA

*I acknowledge the Australian Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples as the first inhabitants of the nation
and the traditional custodians of the lands where we live, learn and work.*

From: Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>

Sent: Tuesday, 28 October 2025 1:12 AM

To: JLM Admin <admin@jlmfamilylawyers.com.au>; Anna Roberts <aroberts@delaneyroberts.com.au>

Cc: Associate JudgeBetts <Associate.JudgeBetts@fcfcoa.gov.au>; reception@delaneyroberts.com.au; Olivia Shedden <oshedden@delaneyroberts.com.au>

Subject: NCC3896/2023 Cooke – Confirmation of Participation and Request for Remote Appearance

Caution: This is an external email. DO NOT click links or open attachments unless you recognise the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Associate,

I confirm that I, **Stephen Christopher Cooke**, the Applicant Father, **intend to participate fully** in the upcoming trial listed for **17–19 November 2025** before His Honour Judge Betts.

I respectfully request that all arrangements be made for me to **attend remotely** (via Microsoft Teams or an equivalent secure video link), as it is **not safe for me to appear in person**. I ask that the Court please provide the necessary connection details and instructions for remote participation at its earliest convenience.

Although I am currently residing overseas, I remain fully committed to these proceedings and to ensuring that the children's best interests are properly considered.

I am finalising my **trial affidavit, tender bundle, and case outline** in accordance with the trial directions. I expect to have all documents filed **by 10 November 2025**, in line with the Court's requirements.

Please confirm receipt of this correspondence and advise of any further procedural steps or details required for remote attendance.

Kind regards,

Stephen Christopher Cooke

Applicant Father (Self-Represented)

 **Email:** stephencooke.c@gmail.com

On Mon, Oct 27, 2025 at 6:17 AM JLM Admin <admin@jlmfamilylawyers.com.au> wrote:

Dear Associate,

I am the ICL in the above matter.

The father is self-represented and was not copied to your email below.

I have copied the father to this email on the most recent email the ICL has for the father.

1. Is the matter still proceeding? **The ICL is unsure whether the father intends to participate in the proceedings.**
2. How long will the matter take (noting that a more detailed trial plan is to be agreed upon closer to the trial)? **3 days**
3. How many witnesses is your side calling? **Single Expert**
4. Are you briefing Counsel, if so, who? **Emily Beckett**
5. Have all trial documents been filed? If not, why not? **Father is yet to file**
6. Are there currently any prospects of settlement? **Possibly dependent on whether the father intends to participate**
7. Has the Family Report writer been put on notice pursuant to the trial directions? (If Applicable) **Yes confirmed to appear at 10am on 19/11/2025 (father is yet to pay his share of the costs for the SE)**
8. Are there any significant issues the Court should be aware of? **As the ICL understands it, the father is now living overseas and has been doing so for some time.**

It is unclear whether the father intends to participate in these proceedings.

Regards

Jo Markham

Lawyer

JLM Family Lawyers

admin@jlmfamilylawyers.com.au

I work flexibly. I am sending you this message now because it's a good time for me, but I do not expect you to read, respond or action it outside your regular hours.

“Liability limited by a scheme approved under Professional Standards Legislation.”

IMPORTANT NOTICE:

This e-mail and any attachments to it is intended only to be read or used by the named addressee. It is confidential and may contain legally privileged information. No confidentiality or privilege is waived or lost by any mistaken transmission to you. If you receive this e-mail in error, please immediately delete it from your system and notify the sender. You must not disclose, copy or use any part of this e-mail if you are not the intended recipient. The sender is not responsible for any unauthorised alterations to this e-mail or attachments to it.

From: Associate JudgeBetts <Associate.JudgeBetts@fcfcoa.gov.au>
Sent: Monday, 27 October 2025 3:06 PM
To: reception@delaneyroberts.com.au; JLM Admin <admin@jlmfamilylawyers.com.au>
Cc: ncc38962023@federalcourts.gov.au
Subject: NCC3896/2023 Cooke [SEC=OFFICIAL]

OFFICIAL

Good afternoon,

I refer to the above mentioned matter listed for trial commencing on 17 November 2025 before his Honour Judge Betts.

The trial will take place in person at Newcastle.

Could you please respond to the following questions as soon as possible:

1. Is the matter still proceeding?
2. How long will the matter take (noting that a more detailed trial plan is to be agreed upon closer to the trial)?
3. How many witnesses is your side calling?
4. Are you briefing Counsel, if so, who?
5. Have all trial documents been filed? If not, why not?
6. Are there currently any prospects of settlement?
7. Has the Family Report writer been put on notice pursuant to the trial directions? (If Applicable)
8. Are there any significant issues the Court should be aware of?

If you have any questions please don't hesitate to contact chambers.

Kind regards

Mireille Brown

Chambers of his Honour Judge Betts

Federal Circuit and Family Court of Australia

e. associate.judgebetts@fcfcoa.gov.au | w. www.fcfcoa.gov.au



FEDERAL CIRCUIT AND FAMILY COURT OF AUSTRALIA

I acknowledge the Australian Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples as the first inhabitants of the nation and the traditional custodians of the lands where we live, learn and work.

Associate JudgeBetts <Associate.JudgeBetts@fcfcoa.gov.au>
To: Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>

Mon, Nov 3, 2025 at 2:31 AM

OFFICIAL

Good morning Mr Cooke,

Please dial into the below link. The matter will be stood in the list while you dial in.

[Quoted text hidden]

Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>

Mon, Nov 3, 2025 at 6:11 AM

To: Associate JudgeBetts <Associate.JudgeBetts@fcfcoa.gov.au>

Cc: JLM Admin <admin@jlmfamilylawyers.com.au>, Anna Roberts <aroberts@delaneyroberts.com.au>, "reception@delaneyroberts.com.au"

<reception@delaneyroberts.com.au>, Olivia Shedden <oshedden@delaneyroberts.com.au>, "ncc38962023@federalcourts.gov.au" <ncc38962023@federalcourts.gov.au>

Dear Associate,

Thank you for your email and for the opportunity to appear by video.

I sincerely apologise for missing the listing today. I did not see the response email advising that the matter had been listed for hearing this morning. My internet connection has been unstable in recent days, and it appears the message came through late or was not fully displayed on my end.

I remain committed to these proceedings and respectfully confirm my intention to participate in all future mentions and the upcoming hearing scheduled for 17–19 November 2025.

If the Court is willing, I respectfully seek leave to continue attending all proceedings remotely due to my current circumstances abroad and the ongoing connectivity limitations.

Kind regards,
Stephen Christopher Cooke
Applicant / Father
Email: stephencooke.c@gmail.com

[Quoted text hidden]

Associate JudgeBetts <Associate.JudgeBetts@fcfcoa.gov.au>

Tue, Nov 4, 2025 at 7:03 AM

To: Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>

Cc: JLM Admin <admin@jlmfamilylawyers.com.au>, Anna Roberts <aroberts@delaneyroberts.com.au>, "reception@delaneyroberts.com.au"

<reception@delaneyroberts.com.au>, Olivia Shedden <oshedden@delaneyroberts.com.au>, "ncc38962023@federalcourts.gov.au" <ncc38962023@federalcourts.gov.au>

OFFICIAL

Good afternoon,

Please see the attached Order made yesterday.

[Quoted text hidden]



Cooke Order 3 November 2025.pdf

287K

Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>

Tue, Nov 4, 2025 at 11:37 AM

To: Associate JudgeBetts <Associate.JudgeBetts@fcfcoa.gov.au>

Cc: JLM Admin <admin@jlmfamilylawyers.com.au>, Anna Roberts <aroberts@delaneyroberts.com.au>, "reception@delaneyroberts.com.au"

<reception@delaneyroberts.com.au>, Olivia Shedden <oshedden@delaneyroberts.com.au>, "ncc38962023@federalcourts.gov.au" <ncc38962023@federalcourts.gov.au>

Dear Associate Judge Betts,

Please find attached my affidavit for filing in the above matter.

This document represents the best that could be produced under the circumstances, given the significant procedural and practical restrictions that have been imposed upon me throughout this process. I have done my utmost to ensure its accuracy and completeness despite these constraints.

While I am deeply disheartened by the treatment I have experienced and remain frustrated by the ongoing obstacles that have limited my ability to participate on equal footing, I trust the Court will at least recognise the effort and integrity with which this material has been prepared.

Respectfully,

Stephen Christopher Cooke

Applicant

(P) NCC3896/2023

[Quoted text hidden]



Stephen Cooke Affidavit Nov 4 2025.pdf
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